piloted a Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism (CCIT) to strengthen the legal framework for countering international terrorism.[86] Even public mood in India, as a *Bombay Times* survey in Mumbai reflected, was supportive of US actions. 80 per cent of the respondents agreed that the attack on Afghanistan was justified, while 53 per cent said that they should be limited only to Afghanistan (rumors of the US venturing into other Middle Eastern countries such as Iraq or Syria were ripe by this point in time).[87]

Despite the MEA's previous warnings to the US of not undertaking unilateral action, after the East Africa bombings, the BJP-led NDA government was pleased with the US military intervention (official UN sanction for military action in Afghanistan came in December 2001, whereas the US had begun bombing much earlier). As part of the initiative, the US Department of the Treasury designated the Jaish-e-Mohammad and the Harkat-ul-Ansar (and some other Pakistan-based militant outfits) as global terrorists on 23 September 2001. However, US Secretary of State Colin Powell, who was in India when the J&K state assembly attacks took place, despite condemning the attack as an act of terror, did not directly hold Pakistan responsible.[88] Instead, in a breathtaking tactical U-turn, Musharraf agreed to abandon the Taliban and side with the US by October 2001. In a call to Musharraf, Powell had made seven specific demands from Pakistan: one, halt Al Qeada operatives at the border; two, blanket over flight and landing rights; three, access to Pakistani air and naval bases as well as borders; four, immediate intelligence and immigration information; five, curb all domestic expression of support for terrorism against the US and its friends and allies (including India); six, cut off supplies to the Taliban; and seven, end diplomatic support to the Taliban.[89]

Musharraf, to Washington's surprise, agreed to support the US in each of the seven actions. In turn, the US would give Pakistan massive aid and ammunition packages. Instead of becoming a nuclear pariah, Pakistan, once again, became a frontline state in America's war, this time on terror, engulfing Indian parliamentarians into a similar and equally impotent debate to that witnessed in 1980, when the Soviet Union invaded Afghanistan. If in 1980 most Indian officials were averse to Soviet actions but reluctantly supported them out of necessity, in 2001 many in India supported US actions but grew skeptical because